

A woman with blonde hair tied back, wearing a purple zip-up jacket over a black tank top and bright pink leggings, is standing in a gym. She is holding a barbell with both hands, lifting it straight up above her head. The barbell has two large black weight plates on each end. The background shows a large window and gym equipment.

Gravitational potential energy

All objects on the Earth's surface have the force of gravity pulling them downwards. This gives them gravitational potential energy. The higher an object is, and the heavier it is, the more gravitational potential energy it has.

The gravitational potential energy of the weight is increased when it is lifted up.

! WOW!

Fleas store **elastic potential energy** in their legs, which allows them to jump **130 times** their body length.